DEFINITION ***JSON Web Tokens*** (JWTs, pronounced "jots") are a standard format for self-contained security tokens. A JWT consists of a set of claims about a user represented as a JSON object, together with a header describing the format of the token. JWTs are cryptographically protected against tampering and can also be encrypted.

6.1 Storing token state on the client

The idea behind stateless tokens is simple. Rather than store the token state in the database, you can instead encode that state directly into the token ID and send it to the client. For example, you could serialize the token fields into a JSON object, which you then base64url-encode to create a string that you can use as the token ID. When the token is presented back to the API, you then simply decode the token and parse the JSON to recover the attributes of the session.

Listing 6.1 shows a JSON token store that does exactly that. It uses short keys for attributes, such as `sub` for the subject (username), and `exp` for the expiry time, to save space. These are standard JWT attributes, as you'll learn in section 6.2.1. Leave the `revoke` method blank for now, you will come back to that shortly in section 6.5. Navigate to the src/main/java/com/manning/apisecurityinaction/token folder and create a new file JsonTokenStore.java in your editor. Type in the contents of listing 6.1 and save the new file.